***Department of Adult Correction Policy and Procedure***

I. PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to provide guidance to North Carolina Department of Adult Correction (DAC) employees on the issuance and usage of State-owned telephones.

II. APPLICABILITY

This policy applies to all DAC employees.

III. DEFINITIONS

A. Business Call

Any telephone call made by a DAC employee to properly discharge their duties as an employee of the State.

B. Centrex or Centrex System

A central office-based telecommunications system which typically provides an individual direct dial number per user and does not require on-site common control equipment such as a key-system or Private Branch Exchange (PBX).

C. Employee

Any person employed by DAC regardless of employment type, including full-time or part-time permanent employees, probationary employees, time-limited employees, and temporary employees.

D. Internal Controls

Systematic processes and procedures put in place to ensure the integrity, accuracy, and efficiency of operations within an organization. These controls help prevent errors, fraud, and abuse by establishing checks and balances, assigning responsibilities, and promoting accountability. In the context of telecommunication expenses, internal controls are designed to prevent misuse of resources by monitoring usage, verifying charges, and ensuring that all expenses serve legitimate, authorized business purposes.

E. Telephone

Refers to any voice communication device or system used for making and receiving local and long-distance calls. This includes traditional landline phones, mobile/cellular devices, VoIP (Voice over Internet Protocol) services, and any other telecommunication methods billed through the North Carolina Department of Information Technology (NCDIT) or approved external vendors.

IV. POLICY

A. Telephones purchased and provided by the State are to be primarily used for official State business. Limited personal use will be tolerated but excessive use is prohibited. Personal use of office landline telephones for long-distance calls is strictly prohibited. All usage, including personal usage, is subject to review by DAC at any time with or without reason and may be subject to public records requests.

B. NCDIT will evaluate all telephone service to determine the need for pre-existing State contracts, existing State contracts, and external vendors. State contracts for cellular phone service includes an adequate number of vendors to cover all areas of the State. No other vendors are allowed for cellular service other than those on State contract, unless authorized by NCDIT, see DAC-PURCH-100 Mobile Electronic Device Acquisition, Disposition, and Use.

C. Any long-distance charges or cellular charges made by an employee that are not State business will be subject to reimbursement by the employee.

D. The Division head or designee shall designate two full-time, permanent State E-Bill designees to access and review their work site telephone bill (NETPLUS E-Bill) through the NETPLUS Customer Care Portal (CCP) system.

E. The Division head or designee shall establish the internal controls necessary to prevent unauthorized or improper use of telecommunication resources to ensure they are used strictly for valid, authorized state business and are protected against misuse.

F. The Division head or E-Bill designee shall establish internal control procedures to determine employees responsible for initiating requests for new lines, line additions or repairs. The individuals responsible for completing and approving the Telephone Order Service Request Form (TO-5) will vary depending on the Division that is initiating the request.

G. No changes to the telephone system may take place until written approval has been received. All request, whether a new line, line additions, or repairs must be submitted with justification for approval through the DAC work site or E-Bill designee and then through the Division's chain of command.

H. Division of Institutions Administration may approve work to be completed by Institutions maintenance staff, based on the type of repair work needed.

I. Payment of Bills

1. Centrex Bills

a) NCDIT bills the Controller's Office directly for Centrex bills, including regular phone charges, cellular phone charges for cellular service on State contract, and telephone credit card charges.

b) Centrex bills will be paid monthly by the DAC Controller's Office.

c) Centrex bills will be available through the NETPLUS E-Billing system by the 15th of the following month and can be accessed through the NETPLUS CCP E-Billing website.

2. Bills Not on State Contract

a) In rare situations where a facility/section needs phone service in a geographic area not covered by a current State contract supplier, NCDIT will authorize a non-State contract with an outside provider.

b) If a facility/section is billed directly by a non-State contract supplier (instead of NCDIT), a DAC CNTR 005 Direct Processing Form shall be submitted to the DAC Controller SharePoint website along with any supporting documentation.

V. PROCEDURES

A. NETPLUS E-Bill Reconciliation

1. Upload the approved reconciled E-Bill to the DAC Controller SharePoint website no later than the last business day of the following month.

2. If the E-Bill cannot be uploaded to SharePoint, send an email with the approved reconciled E-Bill documentation to the Controller's Office at: DAC.Netplusbilling@dac.nc.gov.

B. Accessing Monthly Telephone/Cellular Bills via NETPLUS CCP

1. Navigate to the NETPLUS CCP Portal.

2. Log in using NCID credentials.

3. Check the acknowledgement box at the bottom of the screen and click the Close button.

4. Click the Continue button to proceed to the NETPLUS Home Page.

5. Select Invoice Retrieval to view invoices for individual telephone or cellular lines.

a) Review Charges: Ensure all charges are accurate and pertain to valid State business purposes.

b) Adjustment/Corrections: If adjustments or corrections are needed, print the relevant pages of the E-Bill and clearly note the corrections on the printed copy.

6. Approval of Telephone Charges

a) Print the first page of the detailed report for the month being reviewed, titled "Account Summary."

b) Obtain approval for all charges by having the Division Head or E-bill designee sign the Account Summary page.

c) Only print the Account Summary page and any pages requiring adjustments or corrections.

7. Review Process 1: Electronic Distribution

a) Print the E-bill pages for all charges, organized by cellular phone number.

b) The E-bill designee shall scan and email the relevant E-Bill pages to the assigned cellular phone holders for review. Note that NETPLUS cannot email individual bill directly.

c) Cellular phone holders shall review their charges and send an email confirmation to the E-Bill designee confirming all charges are correct and pertain only to State business or noting any discrepancies.

d) Cellular phone holders shall forward their email confirmation and cellular E-Bill to their supervisor for review and approval.

e) Supervisors shall forward their approval email with the cellular E-Bill to the E-Bill designee.

f) The E-Bill designee shall print the approval email and retain it with the signed Centrex Account Summary page.

g) The entire E-Bill for the cellular phone charges is not sent to the Controller's Office but must be retained at the facility/section for audit purposes.

h) The E-Bill designee will upload the first page of the signed DAC 0123 Account Summary to the DAC Controller SharePoint website for payment processing. Only the "New Charges" amount should be validated/reconciled, not the "Current Balance" amount. Discrepancies must be addressed with NCDIT or the vendor. Vendor issued credits not factored into the next bill must be uploaded to the DAC Controller SharePoint website to offset future bills.

8. Review Process 2: Print and Distribute

a) Print the E-Bill pages for cellular phone charges, organized by cellular phone number.

b) The E-Bill designee shall distribute the E-Bill pages to each cellular phone holder for review and certification of valid and accurate charges by signing their respective E-Bill pages.

c) Once signed, the supervisor shall review and approve the cellular phone charges by signing the cellular phone bill.

d) The approved cellular E-Bill, along with other documentation, is retained by the E-Bill designee for audit purposes.

e) Retain copies of the approved Account Summary page and any corrected pages at the facility/section for audit purposes.

g) The E-Bill designee will upload the first page of the signed DAC 0123 Account Summary to the DAC Controller SharePoint website for payment processing. Only the "New Charges" amount should be validated/reconciled, not the "Current Balance" amount. Discrepancies must be addressed with NCDIT or the vendor. Vendor issued credits not factored into the next bill must be uploaded to the DAC Controller SharePoint website to offset future bills.

## VI. REFERENCES

A. DAC-PURCH-100 Mobile Electronic Device Acquisition, Disposition, and Use

B. DAC CNTR 005 Direct Processing Form

C. DAC Controller SharePoint website

D. Telephone Order Service Request Form (TO-5)